

CA07

Sports, Awards, Books, Persons and Places in the News

About 5-7 questions a paper. The sports block is guaranteed. Awards are near-guaranteed. TIME lists are a documented repeat, asked in RAS Pre 2021 and 2023. Everything below is as of September 2026 — and note that the Asian Games open on 19 September 2026, so those results are NOT in these notes.

Every RAS paper carries a sports block of four to six questions, and it always contains at least one Rajasthani athlete. Add the awards — Khel Ratna, Padma, gallantry, Nobel, Booker, Pulitzer, Oscar, Jnanpith — plus books and their authors, persons in the news and places in the news, and you have the most predictable scoring block in the whole current-affairs section. This chapter is pure pairing: name to event, name to prize, book to author, place to happening.

Sports, Awards, Books, Persons, Places (to Sept 2026)

CWG Glasgow 2026

- 23 Jul - 2 Aug 2026
- India 4th, 39 medals
- 13 gold, 17 silver, 9 bronze
- India topped boxing

Rajasthan angle

- Arundhati Choudhary, KOTA
- Boxing gold, women's 70 kg
- Beat Chantelle Reid, England
- Guaranteed exam target

Cricket

- Men's T20 WC 2026 in India
- Final Ahmedabad, 8 Mar 2026
- India beat NZ by 96 runs
- Women's ODI WC 2025 — first title

Sports awards 2025

- Khel Ratna NOT conferred
- 17 Arjuna awardees
- Committee: Justice A.K. Mishra
- RKPP: Army Paralympic Node

Civilian & gallantry

- Padma 2026 — 131 awards
- 5 Vibhushan, 13 Bhushan, 113 Shri
- 3 Kirti Chakras
- 13 Shaurya Chakras

Nobel 2025

- Peace: Maria Corina Machado
- Literature: Laszlo Krasznahorkai
- Physics, Chemistry, Medicine
- Economics: Mokyr, Aghion, Howitt

Books & letters

- Booker 2025: Flesh, Szalay
- 60th Jnanpith: R. Vairamuthu
- Sahitya Akademi: Crimson Spring
- Pulitzer Fiction: Angel Down

Persons & obituaries

- V. Narayanan, Dhiraj Seth
- Ram Sutar (d. 18 Dec 2025)
- Swaraj Kaushal, Baba Adhav
- TIME 100: Ranbir Kapoor

Places

- Belem, Glasgow, Ahmedabad
- Bharat Mandapam
- Samarkand, Paphos
- Aichi-Nagoya

How to read this chapter — and what RPSC actually does with it

This is the easiest chapter in current affairs to score in, and the easiest to lose marks in through sloppiness. Nothing here needs thinking. Everything here needs exact pairing — who won what, where, in which event, in which year. The commonest mistake in the exam hall is knowing the person but not the event, or the prize but not the year.

- *RAS carries a sports block of 4-6 questions in every paper, and it always includes at least one Rajasthani athlete.*
- *In this window the Rajasthan name is Arundhati Choudhary of Kota. Learn her event and her weight class, not just her name.*
- *For every award learn three things: who, for what work, and in which year's cycle.*
- *For every tournament learn host city, host country, date and the runner-up — RPSC asks the beaten finalist as often as the winner.*
- *Everything below is as of September 2026.*

YAAD RAKHO

Remember four anchor dates for this chapter: 10 October 2025 (Nobel Peace announced), 8 March 2026 (T20 World Cup final at Ahmedabad), 15 April 2026 (TIME 100 list released), 23 July 2026 (Commonwealth Games open at Glasgow). Every chronological-ordering question in this chapter can be solved from those four.

Commonwealth Games 2026, Glasgow — the biggest block in this chapter

The 2026 Commonwealth Games were held at GLASGOW, Scotland, from 23 July to 2 August 2026. Glasgow had also hosted in 2014, so if an option offers Birmingham or Victoria, reject it. India finished **FOURTH** on the medal table with 39 medals — 13 gold, 17 silver and 9 bronze. Learn that split; the total alone is not enough for a statement question.

The story of these Games for India was boxing. India **TOPPED** the boxing medal table with 7 golds and 3 silvers. Seven names give you seven possible questions, and one of them is your Rajasthan answer.

India's boxing medals at Glasgow 2026

Boxer	Category	Medal
Sakshi	Women's 51 kg	Gold
Preeti	Women's 54 kg	Gold
Jaismine	Women's 57 kg	Gold
Priya	Women's 60 kg	Gold
ARUNDHATI CHOUDHARY (Kota, Rajasthan)	Women's 70 kg	Gold — beat Chantelle Reid of England
Sachin	Men's 60 kg	Gold
Ankush	Men's 80 kg	Gold
Lovlina Borgohain	Women's 75 kg	Silver
Jadumani Singh Mandengbam	Men's 55 kg	Silver
Narender	Men's 90+ kg	Silver

- Other Indian golds: Mirabai Chanu (weightlifting, women's 48 kg), Asmita Dey (judo, women's 48 kg), Harsh Singh (judo, men's 60 kg).
- Para athletics golds: Sharmila Dhankar (shot put F57), Dilip Gavitt (100 m T47), Soman Rana.
- Notable silvers: Neeraj Chopra (javelin), Tejaswin Shankar (decathlon), Sarvesh Kushare (high jump), Murali Sreeshankar, Praveen Chithravel (triple jump).
- Gulveer Singh, the long-distance runner, was India's ONLY double medallist at Glasgow 2026.

Where India's 13 golds at Glasgow came from



ASKED IN RAS

RAS keeps a standing sports block and it has always found room for a Rajasthani sportsperson. For the 2026 paper that slot points straight at Arundhati Choudhary of KOTA — Commonwealth Games boxing gold, women's 70 kg. Learn her district, her sport, her weight class and the opponent she beat. If a question asks 'which district', the answer is Kota.

TRAP

Two catches from Glasgow. First, Lovlina Borgohain won SILVER, not gold — she is the famous name, so she is the natural wrong option in a 'who did NOT win gold' question. Second, Neeraj Chopra took silver in the javelin at these Games. Big name does not mean gold. Read the medal colour in the option.

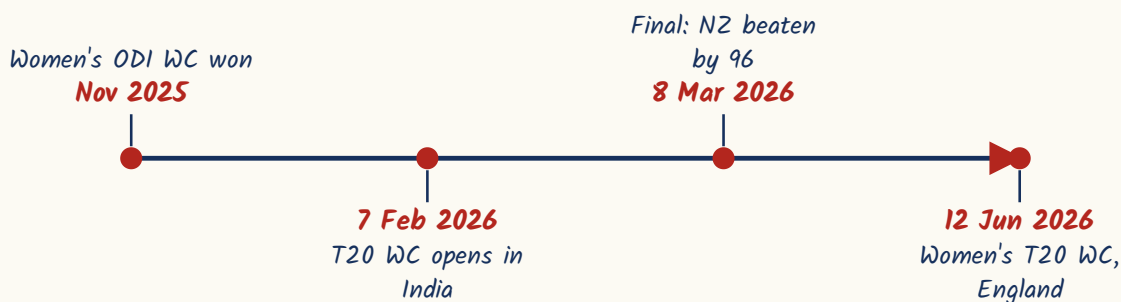
Cricket — the two World Cups India won

Two world titles fall in this window, one men's and one women's, and RPSC will ask at least one of them. Keep the two apart: different year, different format, different opponent in the final.

India's two World Cup wins in this window

ICC Men's T20 World Cup 2026	ICC Women's Cricket World Cup 2025
Hosted by INDIA, 7 Feb - 8 Mar 2026	Played in November 2025
Final at AHMEDABAD on 8 March 2026	India's FIRST ODI World Cup title
India beat NEW ZEALAND by 96 runs	India beat SOUTH AFRICA in the final
India's record THIRD T20 World Cup	A maiden world title for the women's team

Three cricket World Cups - keep them apart



- Three superlatives attach to the men's 2026 win — record third T20 World Cup, first team to win back-to-back T20 World Cups, first team to win the trophy at home.
- The margin, 96 runs, is itself examinable. So is the venue, Ahmedabad.
- The Women's T20 World Cup 2026 was played in England and Wales, 12 June to 5 July 2026 — do not confuse it with the women's ODI title of November 2025.

The rest of the 2026 sports calendar

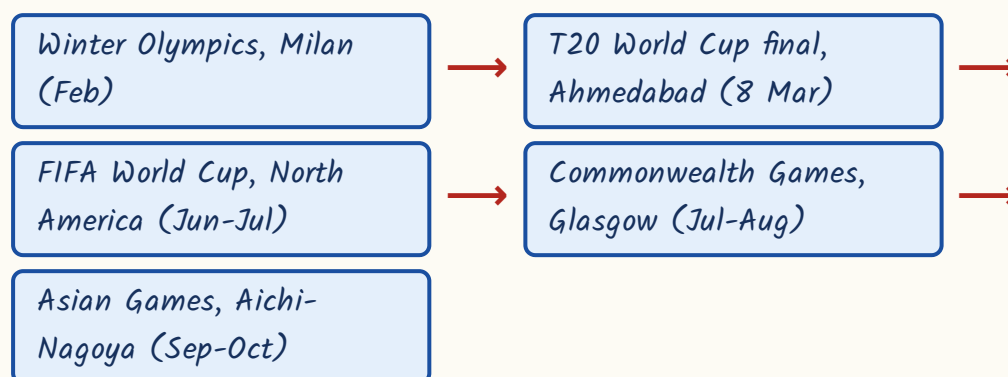
2026 is a crowded sporting year. RPSC does not ask you for results from all of them — it asks host city and host country. So learn the calendar as a list of venues in date order, and you have covered most of what can be asked.

Major events of 2026 — learn host and dates

Event	Host	Dates
Winter Olympic Games	Milan (Milano-Cortina), Italy	6-22 February 2026
Winter Paralympic Games	Milan, Italy	6-15 March 2026
FIFA World Cup	USA, Mexico and Canada	11 June - 19 July 2026
ICC Women's T20 World Cup	England and Wales	12 June - 5 July 2026
Commonwealth Games	Glasgow, Scotland	23 July - 2 August 2026
FIH Hockey World Cups	Belgium and Netherlands	15-30 August 2026
Asian Games (20th)	Aichi-Nagoya, Japan	19 September - 4 October 2026
Youth Olympic Games	Dakar, Senegal	31 October - 13 November 2026

- Chess 2026: the FIDE Candidates and Women's Candidates were at PAPHOS, Cyprus (28 March - 16 April); the Chess Olympiad is at SAMARKAND, Uzbekistan (15-28 September); the World Chess Championship is due in December 2026.
- Badminton: the BWF World Championships 2026 were hosted by INDIA at NEW DELHI, 17-23 August 2026.
- Satwiksairaj Rankireddy and Chirag Shetty exited in the quarter-finals there; the pair had won bronze at the BWF World Tour Finals 2025.
- The 2026 FIFA World Cup was the first with 48 teams.
- Do not pair the Asian Games with Hangzhou — Hangzhou hosted the 2022 edition, which was actually held in 2023. The 2026 host is Aichi-Nagoya, Japan.

The 2026 sporting year in order — solve ordering questions from this



CURRENT LINK

CURRENT LINK, as of September 2026: the 20th ASIAN GAMES open at Aichi-Nagoya on 19 September 2026 and run to 4 October, followed by the Asian Para Games. Every result from those Games falls AFTER these notes were compiled. India's Asian Games medal tally, its gold medallists and any Rajasthani medallist are prime RAS material — you must add them in November. Also still ahead: the Youth Olympics at Dakar and the World Chess Championship in December 2026.

National Sports Awards 2025 — announced August 2026

The National Sports Awards for 2025 were announced in August 2026. The selection committee was headed by retired Supreme Court judge Justice Arun Kumar Mishra. The headline is a negative one, and negatives are exactly what RPSC likes: the MAJOR DHYAN CHAND KHEL RATNA WAS NOT CONFERRED — the committee found no suitable recipient.

- Khel Ratna is India's highest sporting honour; it was renamed from Rajiv Gandhi Khel Ratna to Major Dhyan Chand Khel Ratna in 2021.
- Arjuna Award 2025 — 17 recipients.
- Arjuna Award (Lifetime Achievement) 2025 — I. Arumainayagam, football.
- Dronacharya 2025 (regular) — Parveer Singh (athletics), Chhote Lal Yadav (boxing), Neha Nandkumar Chavan (shooting).
- Dronacharya (Lifetime) 2025 — Dharmendra Singh Yadav (boxing), Virender Kumar (wrestling).
- Rashtriya Khel Protsahan Puraskar 2025 — Army Paralympic Node, Pune. This award goes to institutions, not individuals.

Arjuna Award 2025 — the names most likely to be asked

Sport	Recipients
Athletics	Tejaswin Shankar, Priyanka Goswami, Muhammed Ajmal
Badminton	Treesa Jolly, Pullela Gayatri Gopichand
Chess	Vidit Gujarathi, Divya Deshmukh
Hockey	Lalremsiami, Rajkumar Pal
Boxing	Narender
Shooting	Dhanush Srikanth, Akhil Sheoran
Rowing	Arvind Singh

The four sports awards – who each one goes to



ASKED IN RAS

Sports awards are a standing RAS category. The framing to expect in 2026 is a statement question: 'The Khel Ratna was not conferred in the 2025 cycle' — that statement is CORRECT. RPSC loves an award that was withheld, because most candidates assume every award is given every year.

YAAD RAKHO

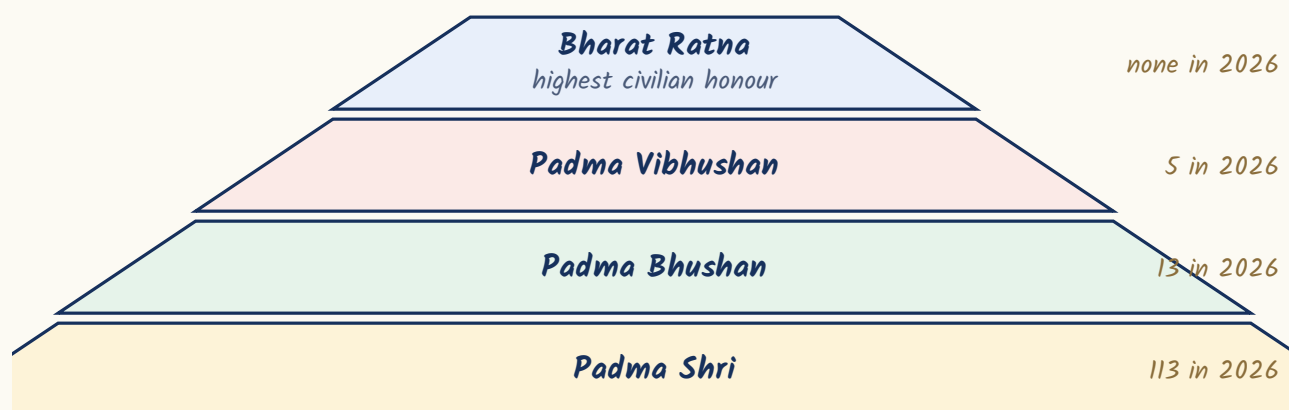
Keep the four sports awards separate by who receives them: Khel Ratna to the single outstanding sportsperson, Arjuna to consistent performers, Dronacharya to COACHES, Rashtriya Khel Protsahan Puraskar to institutions and organisations. If the option names an organisation, the answer is the Protsahan Puraskar.

Civilian and gallantry awards

Two lists, both announced around Republic Day. Padma Awards are civilian; the gallantry awards are military and police. Learn the counts for 2026 and the hierarchy for both, because the hierarchy question is asked more often than the names.

- **Padma Awards 2026** — 131 awards in all: 5 Padma Vibhushan, 13 Padma Bhushan, 113 Padma Shri.
- **Order of the civilian honours:** Bharat Ratna is the highest, then Padma Vibhushan, then Padma Bhushan, then Padma Shri.
- **Republic Day 2026 gallantry list** — President Droupadi Murmu approved 70 gallantry awards (6 posthumous) and 301 other decorations.
- **Three KIRTI CHAKRAS:** Group Captain Prasanth Balakrishnan Nair, Major Arshdeep Singh, Naib Subedar Doleshwar Subba.
- **Thirteen SHAURYA CHAKRAS** were announced in the same list.

The civilian honours, highest first



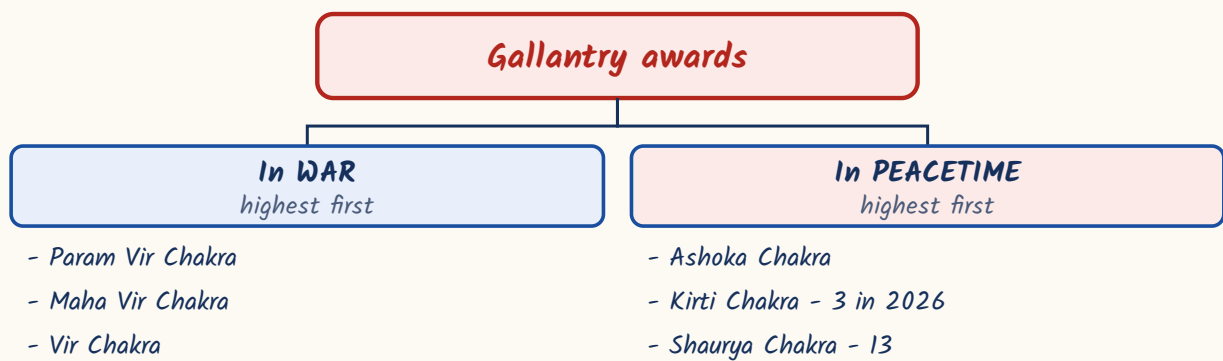
Peacetime gallantry awards, highest first



TRAP

Do not mix the two gallantry ladders. In WAR the order is Param Vir Chakra, then Maha Vir Chakra, then Vir Chakra. In PEACETIME it is Ashoka Chakra, then Kirti Chakra, then Shaurya Chakra. Param Vir Chakra and Ashoka Chakra are equivalent in rank, one for wartime and one for peacetime. RPSC's negative-framed question is usually built on swapping Kirti and Shaurya.

The two gallantry ladders - never mix them



Nobel, Booker, Pulitzer, Oscar, Jnanpith — and the books behind them

Awards questions are matching questions. Build the table in your head as prize-to-person-to-work, and you can answer whichever of the three the paper gives you. Start with the Nobels for 2025 — all six.

Nobel Prizes 2025 — all six

Category	Laureate(s)	Note
Peace	Maria Corina Machado	Venezuelan opposition leader
Literature	Laszlo Krasznahorkai	Hungarian novelist
Physics	John Clarke, Michel Devoret, John Martinis	Quantum tunnelling in an electric circuit
Chemistry	Susumu Kitagawa, Richard Robson, Omar Yaghi	Metal-organic frameworks
Medicine	Mary Brunkow, Fred Ramsdell, Shimon Sakaguchi	Peripheral immune tolerance
Economic Sciences	Joel Mokyr, Philippe Aghion, Peter Howitt	Innovation-driven growth, creative destruction

- **Booker Prize 2025** — David Szalay for the novel 'Flesh', announced 11 November 2025. Szalay is a Hungarian-born British writer.
- **60th Jnanpith Award** — R. Vairamuthu, the Tamil poet and lyricist, announced in 2026; he is the third Tamil writer to receive it (as of September 2026).
- **59th Jnanpith Award** — Vinod Kumar Shukla (Hindi), announced in 2025; the first writer from Chhattisgarh to win it.
- **Sahitya Akademi Awards 2025** — English: Navtej Sarna for 'Crimson Spring', a novel set around the Jallianwala Bagh massacre. Hindi: Mamta Kalia for 'Jeete Jee Allahabad', a memoir.
- **Pulitzer Prizes 2026** — Fiction: Daniel Kraus for 'Angel Down'. Drama: Bess Wohl for 'Liberation'.

Book to author — the pairing RPSC actually asks

Book	Author	Prize
Flesh	David Szalay	Booker Prize 2025
Crimson Spring	Navtej Sarna	Sahitya Akademi 2025, English
Jeete Jee Allahabad	Mamta Kalia	Sahitya Akademi 2025, Hindi
Angel Down	Daniel Kraus	Pulitzer Prize for Fiction 2026
Liberation	Bess Wohl	Pulitzer Prize for Drama 2026

- **98th Academy Awards, 2026** — Best Picture: 'One Battle After Another'. Best Director: Paul Thomas Anderson. Best Actor: Michael B. Jordan for 'Sinners'. Best Actress: Jessie Buckley for 'Hamnet'.
- **79th BAFTA Film Awards 2026** — Best Film: 'One Battle After Another'. Leading Actress: Jessie Buckley for 'Hamnet'.
- **68th Grammy Awards 2026** — Album of the Year: Bad Bunny. Record of the Year: Kendrick Lamar with SZA, 'Luther'. Best New Artist: Olivia Dean.
- **Dadasaheb Phalke Award for 2023** — Mohanlal, presented in 2025.

Other international honours to know

Award	Recipient	Field
Abel Prize 2026	Gerd Faltings	Mathematics
Pritzker Architecture Prize 2026	Smiljan Radic (Chile)	Architecture
Templeton Prize 2026	Simon Conway Morris	Science and religion
Indira Gandhi Prize for Peace, Disarmament and Development 2025	Graca Machel (Mozambique)	Peace and development

ASKED IN RAS

The Sahitya Akademi award in the RAJASTHANI language was asked in RAS Pre 2018 and 2023 — Rajasthani is one of the 24 languages the Akademi recognises, and RPSC treats it as a state-specific question. These notes carry the English and Hindi winners for 2025; before December, look up the RAJASTHANI winner for 2025 on sahitya-akademi.gov.in and write it in the margin here. Do not go into the exam without that name.

TRAP

Nobel Literature is a classic trap because candidates remember the previous year. Han Kang of South Korea won in 2024; the 2025 prize went to LASZLO KRASZNAHORKAI of Hungary. Same trap with the Oscars — Michael B. Jordan won Best Actor for 'Sinners' at the 98th Academy Awards; any other name in the option is a distractor.

CURRENT LINK

CURRENT LINK, as of September 2026: the Booker Prize 2026 winner had not been announced when these notes were written — the Booker is normally announced in November. The Nobel Prizes for 2026 are announced in early October 2026. Both land before your exam. Add them here.

Persons, obituaries, places — and the TIME lists

Three small lists that together produce a question or two every year. Persons in the news means 'who holds this post now'. Obituaries mean 'who was this person'. Places in the news means 'what happened here'. Each one is a single-line pairing.

- V. Narayanan — Chairman, ISRO, and Secretary, Department of Space.
- Lt Gen Dhiraj Seth — Chief of the Army Staff from 13 June 2026.
- Andre Correa do Lago — President of COP30 at Belem.
- Justice Arun Kumar Mishra — headed the National Sports Awards 2025 selection committee.
- Droupadi Murmu — President of India, who approved the Republic Day 2026 gallantry awards.

Obituaries in the window — learn the identification, not the date alone

Name	Who they were	Died
Ram Sutar	Sculptor who designed the Statue of Unity; died aged 100	18 December 2025
Swaraj Kaushal	Senior advocate; former Governor of Mizoram	5 December 2025
Baba Adhav	Social activist; died aged 95	9 December 2025
Kalyan Chatterjee	Bengali actor	9 December 2025

Places in the news — place to event

Place	Why it was in the news
Belem, Brazil	COP30, November 2025
Glasgow, Scotland	Commonwealth Games 2026
Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi	India AI Impact Summit, February 2026
Ahmedabad	ICC Men's T20 World Cup final, 8 March 2026

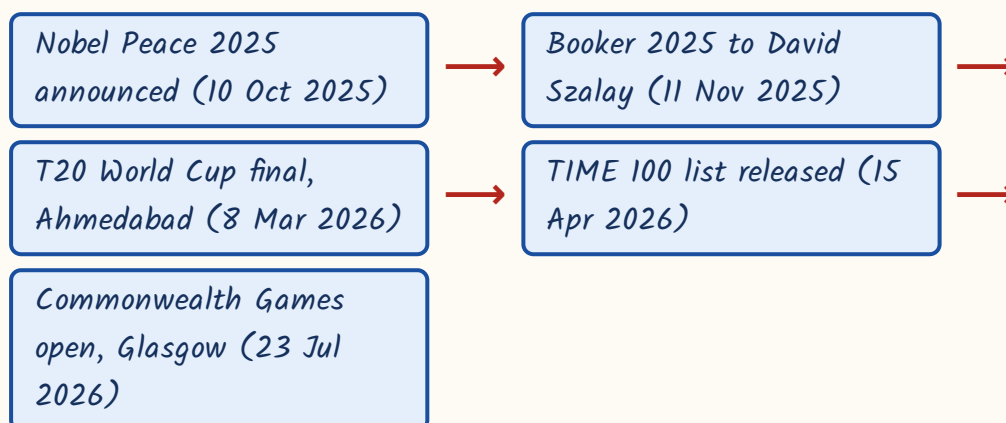
Place	Why it was in the news
Visakhapatnam	Exercise MILAN 2026 and Google's \$15 billion AI hub
Paphos, Cyprus	FIDE Candidates 2026
Samarkand, Uzbekistan	Chess Olympiad 2026
Aichi-Nagoya, Japan	Asian Games 2026

Now the TIME lists — treat this as a named repeat topic, not a stray fact. The TIME 100 Most Influential People list for 2026 was released on 15 April 2026. Three names matter for India: actor RANBIR KAPOOR, whose profile was written by Ayushmann Khurrana; chef VIKAS KHANNA; and Google CEO SUNDAR PICHAI.

ASKED IN RAS

TIME's influential and pioneers lists were asked in RAS Pre 2021 and RAS Pre 2023 — two papers within three years, which in RPSC terms makes it a live category, not a one-off. The question is always 'which Indian featured in the TIME list of year X'. Learn the Indian names for 2026 and be ready to add any new TIME list published in October or November 2026.

Chronology of this chapter — the order RPSC asks



What in this chapter will have moved by December — and where to check

This is the most perishable chapter in the whole book. Between September and December 2026 a full Asian Games, a Nobel season, a Booker and possibly a World Chess Championship all happen. Do not re-read the chapter in December. Keep one loose page titled 'Sept to Dec 2026 — sports and awards', two columns only, the event or prize and the name, and add a line the day you read the news. In the last fortnight that page, not the chapter, is what you revise.

- ASIAN GAMES, Aichi-Nagoya, 19 September to 4 October 2026 — India's medal tally, gold medallists and any Rajasthani medallist. The single biggest gap in these notes.
- Asian Para Games, October 2026 — same treatment.
- Nobel Prizes 2026 — announced in the first half of October. Peace and Literature belong in this chapter.
- Booker Prize 2026 — usually announced in November.
- Youth Olympic Games, Dakar, 31 October to 13 November 2026, and the World Chess Championship due in December 2026.
- National Sports Awards for the 2026 cycle, and whether the Khel Ratna is conferred this time.
- Padma Awards 2027 are announced on the eve of Republic Day 2027 — that is AFTER your exam, so the 2026 list above stays the current one.
- Any new TIME list, and obituaries of major figures between September and December 2026.

CURRENT LINK

CURRENT LINK, as of September 2026: the Sahitya Akademi Award 2025 in the RAJASTHANI language is not recorded in these notes. It has been asked twice in RAS (2018, 2023). Look it up at sahitya-akademi.gov.in and write it into this chapter before December — it is the cheapest mark available in this whole section.

REVISION RECAP

1. Commonwealth Games 2026 — Glasgow, 23 July to 2 August; India 4th with 39 medals (13 gold, 17 silver, 9 bronze).
2. India topped the boxing table at Glasgow with 7 golds and 3 silvers.
3. Arundhati Choudhary of KOTA, Rajasthan — boxing gold, women's 70 kg, beat Chantelle Reid of England. The Rajasthan answer of this window.
4. Lovlina Borgohain took silver (women's 75 kg); Neeraj Chopra took silver in the javelin; Gulveer Singh was India's only double medallist.
5. Other golds: Mirabai Chanu (weightlifting 48 kg), Asmita Dey and Harsh Singh (judo), Sharmila Dhankar, Dilip Gavitt and Soman Rana (para athletics).
6. ICC Men's T20 World Cup 2026 — hosted by India; final at Ahmedabad 8 March 2026; India beat New Zealand by 96 runs for a record third title.
7. ICC Women's Cricket World Cup 2025 — India's first ODI world title, beating South Africa in the final.
8. 2026 hosts: Winter Olympics Milan, FIFA World Cup USA-Mexico-Canada, BWF Worlds New Delhi, Chess Olympiad Samarkand, Asian Games Aichi-Nagoya.
9. National Sports Awards 2025 — Khel Ratna NOT conferred; committee under Justice Arun Kumar Mishra; 17 Arjuna awardees.
10. Arjuna Lifetime 2025 to I. Arumainayagam (football); Rashtriya Khel Protsahan Puraskar to the Army Paralympic Node, Pune.
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12. Republic Day 2026 gallantry — 70 awards including 6 posthumous; 3 Kirti Chakras and 13 Shaurya Chakras.
13. Peacetime gallantry order: Ashoka, Kirti, Shaurya. Wartime: Param Vir, Maha Vir, Vir Chakra.
14. Nobel 2025 — Peace: Maria Corina Machado; Literature: Laszlo Krasznahorkai; Economics: Mokyr, Aghion and Howitt.

15. Booker Prize 2025 — David Szalay for 'Flesh'; 60th Jnanpith — R. Vairamuthu (Tamil); 59th — Vinod Kumar Shukla (Hindi).
16. Sahitya Akademi 2025 — 'Crimson Spring' by Navtej Sarna (English), 'Jeete Jee Allahabad' by Mamta Kalia (Hindi).
17. Oscars 2026 — 'One Battle After Another' (Best Picture), Paul Thomas Anderson, Michael B. Jordan, Jessie Buckley. Phalke for 2023 — Mohanlal.
18. Abel Prize Gerd Faltings; Pritzker Smiljan Radic; Templeton Simon Conway Morris; Indira Gandhi Peace Prize 2025 Graca Machel.
19. TIME 100 of 2026, released 15 April — Ranbir Kapoor, Vikas Khanna, Sundar Pichai. TIME lists were asked in RAS 2021 and 2023.
20. Obituaries — Ram Sutar (Statue of Unity sculptor, 18 Dec 2025), Swaraj Kaushal, Baba Adhav, Kalyan Chatterjee.